

THE  
COMMUNICATIONS  
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD  
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE  
DES COMMUNICATIONS  
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD  
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

 June 2020

Distribution List

1<sup>ST</sup> SENATE MEETING:  
RECORD OF DECISIONS – THURSDAY, 28 MAY 2020

**RECORD OF ATTENDANCE**

| POSITION / APPOINTMENT             | RANK & NAME                                                   |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chair                              | Brigadier-General (Retired) Kevin O'Keefe, Colonel-Commandant |
| Co-Chair                           | Brigadier-General James Lambert, Branch Leader                |
| Member (Branch Leadership)         | Colonel Stephane Roy, Branch Advisor                          |
| Member (Branch Leadership)         | Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert, Branch Chief          |
| Member (Senior Serving C&E GO)     | Major-General Frances Allen                                   |
| Member (C&E Association)           | Major-General (Retired) John Leech                            |
| Member (Serving GO)                | Brigadier-General Martin Girard                               |
| Member (Serving GO)                | Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin                            |
| Member (Reserve Representative)    | Brigadier-General David Awalt                                 |
| Member (Immediate Past Col Cmdt)   | Brigadier-General (Retired) Bill Richard                      |
| Member (Honorary Representative)   | Honorary Colonel Kenneth Lloyd                                |
| Member (Incoming Branch Advisor)   | Colonel Eric Charron                                          |
| Member (C&E Foundation)            | Colonel (Retired) Steve Sibbald                               |
| Member (Home Station CO)           | Lieutenant-Colonel Walter Gamblin                             |
| Member (Affiliates Representative) | Major (Retired) Mike DeNoble                                  |
| Secretariat                        | Major Blair Christie, Branch Adjutant                         |

## RECORD OF DECISIONS

| ITEM             | DISCUSSION / DECISION ITEMS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| <p><b>01</b></p> | <p><b>INTRODUCTORY REMARKS</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe and BGen Lambert – Introduction (1000 hours):</u></p> <p>Chair welcomed all members to the meeting, acknowledged the hard work several individuals (especially Bob Martineau as a key architect of the Charter), and outlined the agenda items. The Branch Leader is interested in understanding how the Senate will influence and the need to bring relevance and cohesion to the Branch / Family activities.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Nil.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <p><b>02</b></p> | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #1: C&amp;E FAMILY CHARTER</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – C&amp;E Family Charter Approval (1004 hours):</u></p> <p>The Charter identified the foundation for all Senate activity going forward. The document outlines the roles &amp; responsibilities of the Senate and will be used to govern C&amp;E Family affairs. The Charter is the principal governance document. Concern raised about 'governing' term as the greater community, including those outside the C&amp;E Branch who may equate 'govern' with the term 'controlling.' The Senate will act as the C&amp;E Family de facto Board of Directors and its methodology for governance is one of cooperation and coordination and not a traditional command and control model.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Senate approved the C&amp;E Family Charter as written (1015 hours).</p> |

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| 03 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #2: COL CMDT AND CoTR SELECTION PROCESS</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Selection Process and ToR for Col Cmdt and CoTR (1016 hours):</u><br/>Briefly outlined the selection process (requiring Senate endorsement) for both the Colonel Commandant and CFJSR's Colonel of The Regiment (CoTR). Point raised that, historically, the Col Cmdt attends a conference (CDA Annual General Meeting) as an <i>Observer</i> and that commentary should be included in the selection process documents confirming as such.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>Senate approved the Col Cmdt and CoTR Selection Process (pending the inclusion of confirmatory sentences regarding attendance at the CDA Annual General Meeting (1021 hours).</p>                                   |
| 04 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #3: HONORARY SELECTION PROCESS</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Selection Process and ToR for Honoraries (1029 hours):</u><br/>Briefly outlined the process for all Branch Honorary Appointments. Point raised to note the honorary appointments receive Ministerial approval and are subject to a host of political criteria (e.g. gender balance factors, ethnic diversity, etc.). Consensus that the Units should not let their selection criteria be curtailed by national policy; Units should nominate the best candidate.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>Senate approved the Honorary Selection Process pending a sentence to reflect that nominations should reflect the cultural, gender and ethnic makeup of the unit and Canada as a whole (1035 hours).</p> |

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| 05 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #4: FOUNDATION AND FINANCIAL UPDATE</b></p> <p><u>Col (Ret'd) Sibbald – Membership SITREP (1036 hours):</u></p> <p>Col Sibbald provided an update on membership status of the Foundation Membership.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>Noted.</p> <p><u>Col (Ret'd) Sibbald – Financial SITREP (1043 hours):</u></p> <p>Col Sibbald provided a presentation on the financial status of the Foundation. Summary as follows:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ <b>Assets</b> ... approximate 1.2 million in the endowment fund, lost \$\$\$ due to COVID-19. Money held in perpetuity and can only extract dividends.</li><li>▪ <b>Revenue</b> ... down on all fronts ... 2018 to 2019 was at \$150K; today it is slightly over \$100K; and</li><li>▪ <b>Expenses</b> ... remain steady. Museum &amp; Branch (along with admin costs) are the chief expense items.</li></ul> <p>Overall, running deeply in the RED and looking at various options to increase revenue and to reduce costs.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>Noted.</p> <p><u>Col (Ret'd) Sibbald – Fundraising SITREP (1047 hours):</u></p> <p>Most fundraising initiatives have ceased. The Foundation has lots of ideas to generate funds but no champions to further them. Several additional ideas were provided including soliciting P070 allotments from CFSCE courses, establishing Branch-wide donations based on rank / appointment, leveraging the United Way (option to channel donations to P070, and other means to collect money as P070 is a 1990's donation theme, and does not align with new generation / new tech.</p> |
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|    | <p>In summary, the Senate noted that while the current status of the Foundation and the challenges it faces both from a personnel and financial perspective are significant perhaps the time has come to step back and review the overall direction of the Foundation. It requires a strategic review of its governance structure to better reflect not only the retired community but also serving members and subject matter experts from business and industry. There is also a need for a broad C&amp;E Family revenue/fundraising strategy</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe will work with Steve Sibbald and John Leech to develop a team to review and recommend a new governance structure for the Foundation and a C&amp;E Family revenue/fundraising strategy (1117 hours).</p> |
| 06 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #5: C&amp;E ASSOCIATION UPDATE</b></p> <p><u>MGen (Ret'd) Leech – C&amp;E Association Update (1119 hours):</u></p> <p>There are <b>three (3) items to discuss:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ 1<sup>st</sup> – The Association has good model for Business Planning (BP) with min income. We continue to work on monuments &amp; plaques (including new CFS Clinton plaque);</li><li>▪ 2<sup>nd</sup> – Fundraising NSTR based on above; and</li><li>▪ 3<sup>rd</sup> – C&amp;E Week 2020: Virtual PD sessions. Propose 2-3 lunch hour sessions as a CoA. Reaching out for topics of interest / POCs:</li></ul> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Noted.</p>                                                                                                                    |

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| 07 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #6: 2023 HRH VISIT</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – 1124 hours:</u></p> <p>Briefing Note (BN) reviewed. The visit is pencilled in for 2023 based on Col Cmdt / Br Adjt private audience last June. The visit aligns with 120<sup>th</sup> anniversary. Consideration to be given to increased <b>work</b> (e.g. the CFSCE Cmdt becomes the <i>Royal Visit Officer</i>) and <b>financial</b> commitments both Public and Non-Public.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Senate recommends to <b>wait out on decision</b> to go forward pending further analysis and financial review / estimate. (1038 hours).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 08 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #7: MUSEUM UPDATE</b></p> <p><u>LCol Gamblin – Military C&amp;E Museum Update (1138 hours):</u></p> <p>The CO Museum provided a presentation on the Museum status. Currently, museum initiatives / challenges include the following:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ 1<sup>st</sup> – <b>Staffing:</b> Class B position assigned to the Branch / Museum SO to assist the Branch Adjutant but also to spearhead museum tasks on behalf of the CO Museum (and bolster a uniformed presence in the facility);</li> <li>▪ 2<sup>nd</sup> – <b>BP:</b> FY 20-21, the museum does not have a BP: it has a budget. So, focus is on to have a fully-fleshed out BP for 21-22. Again, looking to Senate to set and establish priorities; and</li> <li>▪ 3<sup>rd</sup> – <b>Modernize Museum:</b> Artifact DB to digitize physical records and have IM footprint accessible to those outside the museum. Modernize with the times and not solely focus on the brick &amp; mortar point-of-presence (PoP).</li> </ul> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>The Senate acknowledged the continued positive efforts of the CO Museum and his Museum staff. However, the Senate agreed that there still exists a need to review C-of-C / PSP / Mil / C&amp;E relationship of the museum IOT improve D&amp;G / governance from a strategic perspective.</p> |

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|    | <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p><b>Bob Martineau and Kevin O’Keefe</b> shall commence this task to address the chain of command of the Museum, the relationship of the C&amp;E Branch and PSP and the feasibility of establishing an Executive Director for the Museum eliminating the CO Museum secondary duty from the Cmdt CFSCE. This review would also (include research into declaring the establishment a <b>National Museum</b>. Any review must also factor in any previous rationale for PSP involvement in the Museum.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 09 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #8: H&amp;A UPDATE</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret’d) O’Keefe – C&amp;E Branch H&amp;A Overview (1212 hours):</u><br/>Overview provided; Branch Office updated all templates and <i>pro forma</i>.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>C&amp;E Association President owes Branch Adjutant confirmation if the Heritage Award updates are to be applied and posted on CMCEN (1214 hours).</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>Senate requested the Branch Leadership to review the educational grant criteria to ascertain if more members outside the military can be eligible (1220 hours).</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b><br/>Foundation President wishes to have Foundation H&amp;A uploaded onto CMCEN. MTF based on discussions (Br Adjt to raise to Branch Leadership) (1222 hours).</p> |

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| 10 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #9: C&amp;E WEEK 2020</b></p> <p><u>Col Roy – C&amp;E Week 2020 CoAs (1223 hours):</u></p> <p><b>C&amp;E Week is planned for 24-30 October 2020.</b> Decision Point required for either host the event in person (<b>Plan A</b>) or establish it virtually (<b>Plan B</b>). Symposium plans needs to be confirmed as there is a financial component that must be honoured. Plan B must still try to have a social environment (mess dinners, PD sessions, etc.). Other option is to cancel it altogether (<b>Plan C</b>). Col Roy reached out to CO's for input for ideas for PD session. Junior members want additional challenges (skills, sports, PD from operational perspective, etc.). CFSCE expected to have minimal capacity in the Autumn therefore CFSCE staff may be available for more significant participation due to lower students).</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Branch Leadership to confirm which Plan / option shall be pursued and set in motion the required staff actions NLT start of Summer (1230 hours).</p> |
| 11 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #10: NL BATTLEFIELD STUDY TOUR 2020</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Battlefield Study Tour 2020 Cancellation Update (1232 hours):</u></p> <p><b>Tour cancelled.</b> In recovery mode to get back \$150K. Hotels in Holland are forecasted to retain 35% of fees as a penalty. Liaison with Merit Travel continues. No funds in hands as of today. Overall, still in flux. Sponsored soldiers have not means to recoup funds. Paid members have travel insurance. CDS FRAG Os and CANFORGEN 052/20 along with GoC Compensation and Benefits Instructions may permit sponsored soldiers to apply for expenses recovery. C&amp;E Branch will remount Study in2021 assuming health environment permits.</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Noted.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

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| 12 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #11: INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS</b></p> <p><u>Col Roy – Communications Plan (1237 hours):</u></p> <p><b>Increase communication</b> and involve junior members. Move beyond CMCEN, etc. to get message out. Move forward on other agenda items such as a communication strategic.</p> <p>CoAs includes:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ online presence for Q&amp;A;</li><li>▪ Subbie &amp; Member of the Year invited to serve as voice on these boards (such as event planning and H&amp;A nominations); and</li><li>▪ Newsletter (3 months / bi-annual) with unit input.</li></ul> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>The Association produced Strat Comm plan and will provide to Col Roy (1242 hours).</p>                                                                                                                                                           |
| 13 | <p><b>AGENDA ITEM #12: OPEN DISCUSSION FORUM</b></p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Building Naming Policy (1243 hours):</u></p> <p>Building Naming Policy discussed and referenced in the Branch Standing Orders (BSO).</p> <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Senate approved Building Policy SOP (1245 hours).</p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – C&amp;E Annual Golf Tournament Update (1246 hours):</u></p> <p><b>Golf Tournament SITREP.</b> Confirmed that the golf event is a Branch activity which the Foundation can benefit financially from should opportunities to canvass / fundraise be endorsed or if the Foundation decides to further it. Unsure if the golf course will be open this year. Foundation is championing an <i>ad hoc</i> golf event where people can play anywhere, using any size team, and donate money to the Foundation for electing to play if they so choose.</p> |

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|  | <p><b>Action Item:</b></p> <p>Senate confirmed that Golf Event is a Branch Affair. Unit (21 EW Regt) to continue to run golf event with no canvassing / sponsors, and to confirm if golf course remains open this year in August DTG (1249 hours).</p> <p><u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Closing Comments (1250 hours):</u></p> <p>Congratulations to Colonel Charron on his upcoming appointment as Branch Advisor; requesting feedback requested on how the Senate meeting was run / executed, and HCol Lloyd reminded the Senate that Honoraries have influence and financial power: Leverage them.</p> |
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*Blair Christie*

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